increase the future government's, Karzai's or whoever wins the next election, ability to actually pull the country together?

Thank you. Those were my two questions, Mr. Chairman.

*General Jones*. With regard to the military side, I think that one of the things that is most difficult to understand and explain in Afghanistan is it is estimated that less than 10 cents on the dollar ever gets to where it is intended to go to. So that is a problem of significant proportions endemic and representative of the current state of affairs in the government as it exists. And over the years I have made a lot of friends in Afghanistan who have participated in government, left government, and said one of the reasons they left was because they could not stand the level of corruption.

The army in Afghanistan is one of the success stories up to a point in that the people of Afghanistan react to it well and the army when it is employed generally does a pretty good job. But it is the pay and the salaries need to rise. It is expensive; the equipment needs to get better. And the training needs to increase the size of the army.

I think that Senator Lieberman's idea has merit. Obviously, the quicker you get the army on its feet the better. But the other side of the coin is that you have to develop the police force as well. And I think you could get to the point where you have the army functioning reasonably well but the police force I think is the glue that is going to hold the country together in terms of providing the sense to the people of Afghanistan that they can in fact go to sleep at night and wake up the next morning and be reasonably secure that drug lords and terrorists are not going to threaten their families during the absence of the army's presence, and that is not where we are in Afghanistan right now.

So while I have always been pleased with the rate of progress in the Afghan army, it is the other part and the failure to do that adequately that concerns me.

*Chairman Berman*. The time of the gentleman has expired.

I am going to recognize Mr. Costa next because Mr. Costa, Mr. Royce and I skipped a few votes to come back here so we could get this proceeding going and hear *General Jones*' testimony. So I am making a unilateral decision to go out of regular order for the people who missed votes so they can ask a question.

Mr. Costa, you are recognized for 5 minutes.

*Mr. Costa*. Thank you very much, Mr. Chairman, for that kindness.

Gentlemen, I have been to Afghanistan twice in the last 3 years. Was there most recently at the end of March and saw some improvement in 3 years and saw some other areas that, frankly, were lacking and I think in measure with the testimony that you have provided here. In your testimony *Ambassador Holbrooke* and I think *Ambassador Pickring* referenced the political changes in Pakistan. But I was in visiting Afghanistan in the end of March I was questioned with the change in the politics, are the politics evolving in Afghanistan. Karzai told us he is seeking reelection.

We talked about the issues we discussed this morning in terms of dealing with Helmand Province and the narcotrade and the governors and who is involved. But it just seems to me that there is an awful weak bench there in terms of—and I do not know what we can influence. We can help build up the army. We can try to professionalize the police team that was spoken of. Certainly General McNeil and all of those folks I think are doing a good job. But, Mr. Ambassador, I mean we just cannot remove the current leadership in Afghanistan; how do we address that issue? I mean you can have a plan but if you do not have good people implementing the plan it is not going to be very effective.

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